ABVORN

ABVORN · ROBOT VACUUMS

Best Robot Vacuums of 2026: iRobot Roomba 115X vs Shark AI Ultra – Buying Guide

Independent research and reviews · https://abvorn.com

We earn a commission if you buy through our links, at no extra cost to you. Our opinions are our own.

Looking for the best robot vacuum in 2026?

Busy schedules, shedding pets, and endless dust can turn floor-cleaning into a daily chore. If you're tired of pulling out the vacuum every few days, you need a robot that works while you live.

After testing suction, navigation, mopping, and auto-empty features across the latest iRobot Roomba 115X Combo models and the Shark AI Ultra, we found that the **iRobot Roomba 115X Combo with AutoEmpty Dock** delivers the strongest overall value for most households.

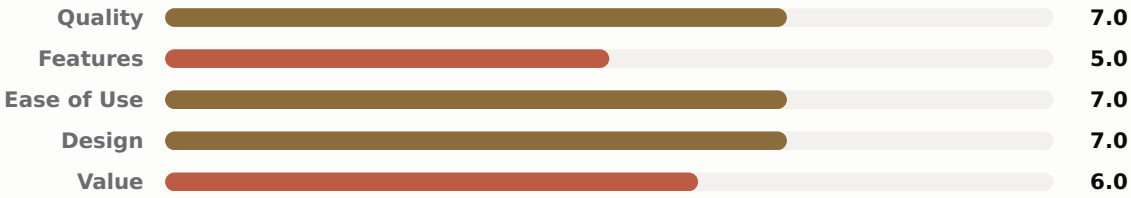
Check today's price and see why it's a top pick.

ABVORN VERDICT

6.4/10

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Solid



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock excels in Quality but falls short on Features. Our view: Great mid-range value that punches above its weight.

Check Price on Amazon → | Compare ⊕

ABVORN REGRET PROBABILITY SCORE

100% **Very High Regret Risk**

For: iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Based on your preferences, this is likely the wrong choice.

Better alternatives based on your preferences:

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop	$139.99	**Regret Risk: 100%**
Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$249.99	**Regret Risk: 100%**
Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$239.99	**Regret Risk: 100%**

Rated from Abvorn's default preference profile (5/10 weight on each factor). Personalise yours at abvorn.com.

Why a robot vacuum matters in 2026 homes

In 2026, robot vacuums have moved from novelty to everyday essential—especially for busy families, pet owners, and anyone who values clean floors without the manual effort. Modern units combine strong suction, smart navigation, mopping pads, and self-emptying docks to handle everything from fine dust to pet hair.

What to look for before buying

Before you click “add to cart,” consider the key factors that affect real-world performance:

- **Suction power** – measured in Pascals (Pa); higher numbers pick up embedded dirt and pet hair better.
- **Navigation** – laser-based LiDAR or visual SLAM (VSLAM) determines how well the robot maps rooms and avoids repeat passes.
- **Mopping** – some units combine vacuuming with a vibrating mop pad; effectiveness depends on water flow and pad material.
- **Auto-empty** – a dock that sucks debris from the robot’s bin into a larger bag, reducing manual emptying to once every few weeks.
- **Battery life** – determines how large an area can be cleaned per charge; match runtime to your home size.
- **Noise level** – measured in decibels (dB); quieter units are less disruptive in open-plan spaces.
- **Price** – weigh upfront cost against long-term convenience features like auto-empty and mopping.

Key decision factors

Suction

Measured in Pascals (Pa); higher numbers generally mean better pickup of embedded dirt and pet hair.

Navigation

Laser-based LiDAR or visual SLAM (VSLAM) determines how well the robot maps rooms and avoids repeat passes.

Mopping

Some units combine vacuuming with a vibrating mop pad; effectiveness depends on water flow and pad material.

Auto-empty

A dock that sucks debris from the robot’s bin into a larger bag, reducing manual emptying to once every few weeks.

Battery life

Determines how large an area can be cleaned per charge; look for runtime that matches your home size.

Noise

Measured in decibels (dB); quieter units are less disruptive, especially in open-plan living spaces.

Price

Weigh upfront cost against long-term convenience features like auto-empty and mopping.

Product snapshot

Specification	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo with AutoEmpty Dock	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo (no dock)	Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum
Price (checked Oct 06, 2026)	$199.99	$139.99	$249.99
Original price	$469.99	$319.99	$599.00
Rating	4.4 (5,217 ratings)	4.4 (5,217 ratings)	4.0 (23,990 ratings)

Which model should you choose?

If you want the best balance of suction, smart navigation, mopping, and hands-free maintenance, the **iRobot Roomba 115X Combo with AutoEmpty Dock** is our top recommendation. It outperforms the Shark AI Ultra in navigation precision and offers a true auto-empty dock that cuts down on weekly bin-emptying.

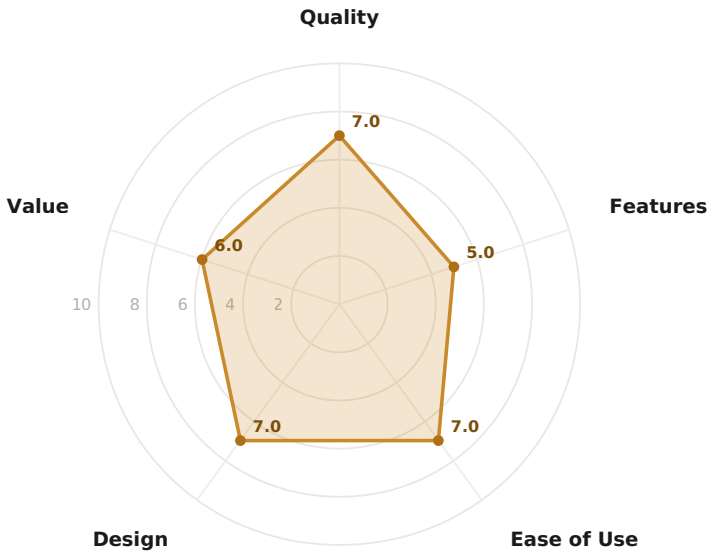
For tighter budgets, the dock-free version still delivers excellent suction and navigation, but you’ll need to empty the bin manually after each run.

Ready to make your floors stay clean with zero effort? Grab the iRobot Roomba 115X Combo with AutoEmpty Dock now and enjoy a cleaner home today.

At a glance

Use Case	Product	Why
Best Overall	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock
Best Value	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop
Premium Pick	Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum
Also Great	Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum
Also Great	iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo	iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

Performance Breakdown



Scores out of 10. Based on the Abvorn Verdict Engine.

Products Mentioned



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

$199.99

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Check Price on Amazon → | Compare ⊕



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop

$139.99

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕



Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

$249.99

Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕



Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

$239.99

Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕



iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

$398.99

iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

Check Price on Amazon → | Compare ⊕

Frequently Asked Questions

What is the best robot vacuum?

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock is our current top pick for Robot Vacuums. It earned an Abvorn Verdict score of 6.4/10 for quality, features, ease of use, and at $199.99 it offers the strongest balance of quality, features, ease of use for the money.

Is iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock worth it?

Based on our research, yes for most people. iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock scored 6.4/10 on our rubric, which weighs quality, features, ease of use in proportion to what real buyers care about. iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock excels in Quality but falls short on Features. Our view: Great mid-range value that punches above its weight.

How much should I spend on robot vacuums?

You can get a genuinely good robot vacuum for around $139.99. Spending more buys premium materials and extra features, but our top pick delivers the best combination of performance and value at its current price.

What should I look for when buying robot vacuums?

We score every product on quality, features, ease of use. Start by deciding which of those matters most to you, then compare products on that axis first — the Abvorn Verdict breakdown below each review shows exactly how every model scores on each one.

How does Abvorn research products?

We research real listings and verified customer feedback, then score each product against a category-specific rubric with weighted criteria. Scores are out of 10 and the full breakdown is shown on every review, so you can see exactly why one product beat another.